BUCKEYE EXPERIMENTAL AERONAUTICS

Project Overview

Buckeye Experimental Aeronautics (BExA) is a student led aerospace engineering program focused on high-speed, jet-powered, remotely piloted aircraft and autonomous systems. Our mission is to design, build, and flight test increasingly advanced aircraft while developing the next generation of engineers through hands-on experience, rigorous engineering practices, and a culture of innovation. **We are building more than an aircraft – we are building the next generation of engineers.**

LEADERSHIP

President
Viktor Bakhurynskyy

Technical Director
Sam Patterson

Vice President
Quinn Cohen

Advisor
Dr. Matthew H. McCrink

BExA PILLARS

SHORT-TERM FOCUS

- Establish the organization and operating structure
- Recruit, train, and develop members
- Integrate an electric ducted fan (EDF) into a test platform
- Develop autonomy, avionics, and telemetry systems
- Create safety, documentation, and review processes
- Begin microturbine ground-testing

LONG-TERM FOCUS

- Progress from EDF platforms to turbine powered demonstrators and, ultimately, a record-orientated high-speed aircraft
- Pursue a Guiness World Record in high-speed flight
- Provide an experimental test bed for undergraduate and graduate research
- Provide students with real-world experience in complex aerospace systems

Team Longevity

We aim to build a team that can last for decades through strong leadership, well-defined processes and a culture of accountability and ambition. By documenting our work, mentoring new members, and maintaining a clear vision, we will ensure that each generation builds upon the last continues pushing the boundaries of student lead engineering organizations.